Makenna Smutz

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Social

makenna.dev

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Co-founder @ Cirrus 9 Candy

June 2024 - current

- Building an e-commerce brand for Organic Cotton Candy using local fruit, maple syrup and other innovative ingredients. Non of the junk, more of the flavor.

Design Engineer @ Navattic

June 2024 - current

- Hired as design engineer #1 to invest more in quality UX and bridge the voice of the customer into engineering.
- I lead the small design team through sprints of product and design system work as well as code for signature UI elements and interactions.
- I created and polished our design system, compass-ui built off of primitives and with our brand's interactive flair.

Design/Product Engineer @ Halite.app

September 2023 - June 2024

- I designed, prototyped, tested and built both the app and marketing website.
- The app is built with Chakra UI, Saas UI, TypeScript, Next.js, and GraphQL, and the website with Framer
- This is a data and charts heavy product, so I dove deep into the dense display of data, by utilizing React table, Chart.js and Framer Motion where applicable

Design Engineer @ Roopairs * contract

November 2023 - January 2024

- I implemented the bespoke design system based on their existing repo and wants using CSS modules, Radix primitives and in React
- I implemented the many of the components in both Figma and in the codebase. I also worked with the team to refactor them in the product.
- A significant part of the project was in educating the team on design system principles.

Design Engineer → Product Engineer @ Whop.com

February 2023 - August 2023

- Built a bespoke design system with Tailwind, Radix UI, and Storybook. Shipped 65+ production-ready components that earned strong reviews and full adoption across engineering. The project grew from internal use to open source, unlocking a developer-app platform that launched on top of it.
- Led design polish and implementation across the product, including micro-animations with accessible fallbacks. Mentored designers and engineers on design systems.
- Owned documentation in Storybook, ran release demos, and hosted open critiques to keep the system clear and shared.
- Built custom Figma dev tooling for handoff, wired directly to the component API.